

Lawrence T Makhafola

Junior Data Analyst

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PROFILE

Aspiring Data Analyst with a strong foundation in Mathematical Sciences and hands-on experience in SQL, Excel, and Power BI. Completed multiple end-to-end projects analyzing structured datasets to identify trends, evaluate performance, and support business decision-making. Experienced in data cleaning, exploratory analysis, DAX measure development, dashboard development, and database design. Holder of the Databricks Fundamentals accreditation and Cisco Introduction to Data Science certification. Focused on developing job-ready analytical skills within the Retail, Financial Services, and Telecommunications sectors.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Microsoft Power BI** — Dashboards, KPI Cards, Slicers, Page Navigation, DAX Measures, Calculated Columns, Executive Reporting.
- **Data Visualization** — Power BI, KPI Design, Dashboard Layout, Executive Reporting, Insight Communication.
- **Advanced Excel** — Pivot Tables, XLOOKUP, INDEX/MATCH, Power Query, Data Cleaning, Interactive Dashboards.
- **Databricks SQL** — CTEs, Persistent Views, Window Functions, Joins, Date Functions, Aggregations, Data Validation.
- **Analytical Skills** — KPI Development, Trend Analysis, Customer Segmentation, Revenue Analysis, Promotion Effectiveness, Inventory & Stockout Analysis.
- **AI-Assisted Analytics** — ChatGPT, Claude, Prompt Engineering, Data Exploration, Documentation, Insight Generation, Workflow Acceleration.
- **Documentation** — Data Storytelling, GitHub README Documentation, Business Recommendations.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Academy Accreditation – Databricks Fundamentals** | Databricks | May 2026
 - Credential ID: 181390945
- **Introduction to Data Science** | Cisco Networking Academy | May 2026
 - Cert ID: 83a4d0bd-d2f9-4ddf-9a2d-d10302515631

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Walmart Retail Performance Analysis | Excel, Databricks SQL & Power BI | 05/2026

- **End-to-End Analysis:** Validated and analyzed 5,000 retail transactions across 5 US store locations spanning January to September 2024, performing 7 structured SQL queries covering store performance, customer loyalty, promotion effectiveness, weather impact, and inventory health.
- **Dashboard:** Developed a 4-page interactive Power BI dashboard with slicers, KPI cards, DAX measures, and navigation covering Sales Overview, Customer & Loyalty Analysis, Operations & Inventory, and an Executive Summary with business recommendations.
- **Key Findings:** Identified a 51.86% stockout rate putting \$8.01M revenue at risk despite accurate demand forecasting; Electronics drove 52% of total revenue; Bronze customers carry the highest average income at \$70,932 but remain in the lowest loyalty tier, representing an untapped upgrade opportunity.

Nova Retail Group — Sales Performance Analysis | [Databricks SQL & Power BI](#) | 04/2026

- End-to-End Analysis: Built 15 permanent Databricks SQL views across 4 tiers — basic queries, intermediate joins, advanced window functions, and business intelligence questions — across 2,500 orders spanning 2023 and 2024.
- Dashboard: Developed a 4-page interactive Power BI dashboard with slicers, KPI cards, and navigation covering Sales Overview, Customer & Channel Analysis, Products & Profitability, and Customer Satisfaction.
- Key Findings: Identified 9.63% YoY revenue growth; Electronics drives 74% of R16.88M total revenue; Online channel outperforms Store by 2x; Home Appliances carries the highest profit margin despite being second in revenue.

E-Commerce Sales Funnel Analysis | [Databricks SQL & Power BI](#) | 02/2026 – 03/2026

- Funnel Optimization: Identified a 16.5% page-view-to-cart drop-off as the primary conversion bottleneck across 5,000+ records.
- Revenue Insight: Quantified R88,000 total revenue over 35 days, with an average order value of R106.51 and R17.60 revenue per visitor.
- Traffic Source Analysis: Organic search was the top channel with 2,038 views and 204 purchases, outperforming paid ads and email combined.

E-Commerce Sales Performance Analysis | [Excel](#), [Databricks SQL & Power BI](#) | 01/2026 – 02/2026

- Data Cleaning: Resolved formatting issues, missing values, and inconsistent dates across a raw e-commerce dataset in Excel before loading into Databricks.
- SQL Analysis: Wrote 7 structured SQL queries covering revenue by category, cancellation rates, and order trends.
- Key Finding: Identified a 15.46% cancellation rate; Books emerged as the top revenue-generating category.

Coffee Orders Sales Analysis | [Excel](#) | 03/2026 – 04/2026

- Geographic Segmentation: Analyzed sales across 3 countries (2019–2022), revealing the US as the dominant market at 78.96% of total revenue.
- Customer Analysis: Ranked Top 5 customers by sales value to support targeted loyalty and retention strategies.
- Interactive Dashboard: Built a dynamic Excel dashboard with slicers for country, loyalty card, roast type, and date for self-service reporting.

EDUCATION

BSc Mathematical Sciences | Sefako Makgatho Health Sciences University, Pretoria | 01/2025 – Present

- Relevant courses: Computer Science, Statistics, Applied Mathematics, Mathematics

Data Analytics Bootcamp | Witle Academy | 01/2026 – Present

- Courses: Excel, SQL, Python, Power BI, Insight Presentation, Data Modelling

WORK EXPERIENCE

E-Hailing Driver | Bolt & Uber, Pretoria | 11/2022 – 02/2025

- Managed daily transport operations, consistently maintaining a high driver rating through professional service and effective communication.

Stock Packer | Sibanyoni Hardware, Kwamhlanga | 11/2018 – 01/2020

- Supported daily store operations in a local hardware and building materials retailer.

LANGUAGES

English — Fluent | Zulu — Fluent | Sotho — Fluent | Afrikaans — Basic